



## YOU ARE 27 WEEKS EXACTLY

### 91 days to go

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#### YOUR BABY TODAY

This baby looks quite upset. Your baby often makes strange and funny faces in the uterus. It's as if he is practicing every type of facial expression in preparation for after the birth when these will be one of the tools he uses to communicate his needs and emotions.

**“As you soak in a relaxing bath, it's an amazing sight to look at your baby moving and stretching your belly.”**

Your belly is a marvelous thing. It's already changed so much over the last 27 weeks and will continue to grow until you give birth.

Inside that belly your growing baby is moving around. When your baby is kicking and turning around, take the time to look down, and you may be able to see him move or even see the imprint of a foot as it kicks you.

While you're taking a bath is a good time to watch your belly—you may find that your baby is more active around this time because you're relaxed—and you can take the time to observe his movements.

Keep your partner involved when your baby is active by encouraging them to touch your bump and talk to the baby.

#### FOCUS ON PARTNERS

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**Being pregnant is more tiring** than most women anticipate. In the third trimester, your partner's bladder is under increased pressure, and this can cause her to wake frequently during the night to use the bathroom. The size of her belly starts to become cumbersome, and it can be difficult to find a comfortable sleeping position. Other changes, including shifting internal organs and changes in hormone levels, can contribute to her restlessness. And if she's having trouble sleeping, you are likely to be disturbed too. The end result is that both of you may feel tired much of the time.

Unfortunately, there is no easy answer. Going to bed earlier can help, but having some time to relax together before bed is just as important. The bottom line is that disrupted sleeping patterns will continue to be the norm for both of you, and this may be nature's way of readying you for the many sleepless nights ahead!

#### ASK A DOCTOR

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